THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

CLASS VIII — ENGLISH · MID-TERM PRACTICE PAPER

Session 2026–27 · Set 02

Class: VIII	Subject: English	Time: 2½ Hours	Max. Marks: 60

General Instructions:

1. The Question Paper is divided into FOUR sections. Section A: Reading 14 marks; Section B: Grammar 14 marks; Section C: Writing 12 marks; Section D: Literature 20 marks.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.
3. Marks are indicated against each question.
4. Read the questions carefully before answering.

SECTION A — READING (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**

The Dance of the Honeybee

When a honeybee finds a rich patch of flowers, it does not keep the secret to itself. It flies back to the hive and performs a special 'waggle dance' on the honeycomb. The bee moves in a straight line while shaking its body from side to side, then loops back and repeats the pattern. The angle of the straight run shows the direction of the flowers in relation to the sun, and the time the bee spends waggling tells its sisters how far they must fly.

Nearby bees touch the dancer with their antennae to learn the message. Within minutes, dozens of workers leave the hive and head straight for the flowers. Scientists who first decoded this language were amazed that a creature with a brain smaller than a sesame seed could share such exact information.

1. Where does the honeybee perform the waggle dance? **1**

(a) On a flower (b) On the honeycomb
(c) On a tree trunk (d) In the air near the sun

2. What does the angle of the straight run of the dance show? **1**

(a) The distance of the flowers (b) The number of bees needed
(c) The direction of the flowers (d) The quality of honey

3. How do the other bees receive the message? **1**

(a) By smelling the flowers
(b) By touching the dancer with their antennae
(c) By hearing a buzzing sound
(d) By following the queen

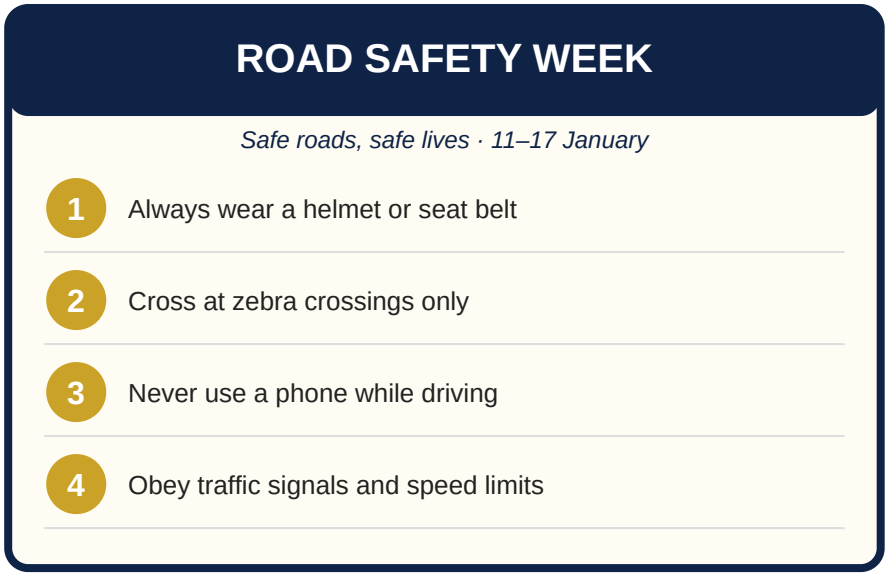
4. Which of the following best describes the main idea of the passage? **1**

(a) Bees collect honey only in summer
(b) Honeybees share information through dance
(c) Bees are afraid of the sun
(d) The queen bee gives orders

5. Why were the scientists 'amazed' when they decoded the bees' language? Answer in two points. **2**

6. What does the time spent waggling tell the other bees? **1**

Q2. Study the poster carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**



Every year thousands of accidents on Indian roads are caused not by faulty vehicles but by careless human behaviour. Over-speeding, ignoring signals and the use of mobile phones while driving are leading causes. Children are especially at risk when they cross busy roads outside schools. The traffic police and schools organise a Road Safety Week every year to remind everyone that a few simple rules can save lives.

1) According to the passage, what causes many road accidents? **1**

(a) Faulty vehicles (b) Careless human behaviour
(c) Bad weather (d) Narrow roads only

2) Which rule on the poster protects a pedestrian outside a school? **1**

(a) Wear a helmet (b) Cross at zebra crossings only
(c) Never use a phone while driving (d) Obey the speed limit

3) Rohan is about to ride his cycle on a main road. Which poster instruction should he follow? **1**

(a) Cross at zebra crossings (b) Always wear a helmet
(c) Obey the school bell (d) Switch on the radio

4) Who is the poster mainly meant for? **1**

(a) Only traffic policemen (b) All road users
(c) Only car drivers (d) Only children below five

5) Why is it important to read the poster along with the passage? Give two reasons. **2**

6) Why do schools organise Road Safety Week? **1**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q3. Do as directed.

I. Attempt any 4 from the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options. **(4x1=4)**

1) The teacher asked the students to _____ their phones before the exam.

(a) switch off (b) put on
(c) look after (d) take after

2) I could not _____ what he meant by that remark.

(a) make out (b) make up
(c) put away (d) turn down

3) The plane will _____ at 6 a.m. tomorrow.

(a) take off (b) take after
(c) take up (d) take in

4) She _____ her grandmother, as they both have the same smile.

(a) takes after (b) looks up

(c) gives away (d) puts off

5) We ran _____ of milk, so I went to the shop.

(a) out (b) off

(c) up (d) down

II. Attempt any 4 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(4x1=4)**

6) Choose the correct preposition: The cat jumped _____ the table.

(a) onto (b) between

(c) among (d) beside

7) She has lived in Jaipur _____ 2019.

(a) for (b) since

(c) from (d) during

8) The word 'quickly' in the sentence 'He ran quickly' is an adverb.

(State True or False.)

9) Choose the correct word. The sun rises _____ the east. (in / on / at) *(in / on / at)*

10) Identify the adverb in: *The old man walked slowly.*

(a) old (b) man

(c) walked (d) slowly

III. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(3x1=3)**

11) Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. We _____ (visit) the fort last Sunday.

12) Choose the correct sentence.

(a) He go to school daily. (b) He goes to school daily.

(c) He going to school daily. (d) He gone to school daily.

13) 'Has' is used with the pronoun 'they'.

(State True or False.)

14) Choose the correct verb: She _____ a letter now.

(a) write (b) writes

(c) is writing (d) wrote

IV. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(3x1=3)**

15) Choose the correct article: _____ honest man always speaks the truth.

(a) A (b) An

(c) The (d) No article

16) Fill in the blank with a, an or the. _____ moon moves round the earth.

17) We use 'an' before a word that begins with a vowel sound.

(State True or False.)

18) Choose the sentence with the correct use of articles.

(a) She bought a umbrella. (b) He is an university student.

(c) I saw an elephant at the zoo. (d) The Ganga are a long river.

SECTION C — WRITING (12 Marks) — 12 marks

Q4. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) Draft a notice in about 50 words for your school notice board informing students of Classes VI–VIII about a Book Fair to be held in the school library from 15 to 17 December. You are Ravi/Ruchi, the Library Prefect.

O R

(B) Write a story-like account in 100–120 words of a day when you helped a stranger in need. Mention who needed help, what you did, how they reacted and what you felt.

Q5. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) You are a resident of Vidyadhar Nagar, Jaipur. Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner in 100–120 words about stray dogs causing fear among children in your colony. Request him to take suitable action.

O R

(B) You are Sonal/Sohan. Write a letter to the Manager of 'Bright Music Academy', Jaipur in 100–120 words enquiring about guitar classes: batch timings, fees, duration of the course and availability of instruments.

SECTION D — LITERATURE (20 Marks) — 20 marks

Q6. Read the following passage and answer any four out of the five questions that follow: **(4x1=4)**

Verghese Kurien, born in Kozhikode in 1921, is remembered as the father of India's White Revolution. He worked with milk farmers in Kaira district of Gujarat, who were cheated by middlemen and sold milk at very low rates. By helping them form a cooperative, he ensured that farmers got a fair price. This idea grew into the brand Amul and later into Operation Flood, which made India one of the largest producers of milk in the world. Kurien insisted that the cooperative belonged to the farmers, not to any one individual.

a) Kurien is called the father of India's _____ Revolution. (White / Green) *(White / Green)*

b) Farmers of Kaira district were cheated by middlemen.
(State True or False.)

c) What did Kurien's cooperative ensure for farmers?
(a) Free cattle (b) A fair price for milk
(c) Foreign jobs (d) Cheaper fodder only

d) Kurien insisted that the cooperative belonged to:
(a) the government (b) the farmers
(c) the middlemen (d) foreign companies

e) Why do you think the cooperative model succeeded?

Q7. Read the following extract and answer any two out of the three questions that follow: **(2x2=4)**

A little seed lay in the ground,
It slept without a sound;
The rain came down, the sun shone bright,
And it rose to greet the light.

a) Where did the little seed lie?

b) Which two things helped the seed to grow?

c) Pick out a word from the extract that rhymes with 'ground'.

Q8. Answer any four out of the five questions given below. **(4x3=12)**

a) What impact do you think the story of Major Somnath Sharma had on the young soldiers who heard about his bravery?

b) 'I Too Had a Dream' shows that dreams need hard work. Explain with reference to Verghese Kurien.

c) Why is Tenali Ramakrishna considered a 'wit that won hearts'? Give three reasons.

d) What contrast does the poet show between the young people in the poem 'Somebody's Mother' and the old woman?

e) Compare the values shown by Major Somnath Sharma and Verghese Kurien in two points each (any one common value).